

**OUR JOURNALISM
WORKS
FOR YOU**

While Washington spins the latest economic data and billionaires hedge their bets, working Americans are feeling the very real squeeze of rising costs, and sudden instability. HuffPost reports on the real economy – the one that impacts you.

JOIN HUFFPOST

Already a member? [Log in to hide these messages.](#)

‘The Timing Was So Strange’: Joe Scarborough Questions Melania Trump’s Epstein Claims

The "Morning Joe" co-host isn't ready to accept the first lady's recent claim that she was never friendly with the disgraced financier.

By Curtis M. Wong

Apr 10, 2026, 12:47 PM EDT | **Updated** 10 hours ago

63 Comments





00:00

01:48

[Joe Scarborough](#) isn't ready to accept [Melania Trump](#)'s claim she was never friendly with disgraced financier [Jeffrey Epstein](#), arguing the first lady's latest remarks have done little to quash speculation.

On Thursday, Trump [delivered a televised address](#) from the White House in which she went to lengths to distance herself from Epstein, who [died](#) by an apparent suicide in 2019 while awaiting trial on charges of sex trafficking underage girls. The first lady dismissed reports linking her to Epstein as "lies" and also downplayed a 2002 email with Epstein's accomplice, [Ghislaine Maxwell](#), as "casual correspondence."

Scarborough, however, wasn't convinced. On Friday's installment of MS Now's "Morning Joe," the co-host deemed Trump's address "beyond bizarre."

came out of nowhere, and secondly, that she would actually pretend that she didn't know who he was or that she had no relationship with him," he said.

Watch Scarborough's remarks on Trump below.

'Just beyond bizarre': Joe puzzled by first lady's impromptu

MS NOW



Watch on

He and co-host Mika Brzezinski raised doubts about Trump's email with Maxwell — [dated Oct. 23, 2002](#), and released publicly during a U.S. Justice Department document dump in January of this year — noting that the first lady's decision to sign the note, "Love, Melania," felt more than casual.

"Again, everybody's waiting for another shoe to drop," he said. "I don't know if it will or not, but again, the timing of that was so strange, especially bringing up something that obviously the president doesn't want brought up and calling for hearings."

“That’s just the opposite of what the president has been talking about for months,” he added.

President [Donald Trump](#) told [MS Now’s Jacqueline Alemany](#) on Thursday that he didn’t “know anything about” his wife’s plans to speak to the media about Epstein. “She didn’t know him,” he said.

However, a source later [told CNN](#) the president was aware of the first lady’s plans to issue a public statement.

THIS MOMENT DEMANDS TRUTH.

SUPPORT HUFFPOST

In a deeply divided country, journalism is a safeguard. Members make it possible to question authority, investigate impact, and protect democratic accountability beyond the headlines.

“Our fierce, independent reporting and unvarnished perspective hold power to account and inform millions of readers. Please support this hard-hitting journalism.”



Whitney Snyder
Editor-in-Chief HuffPost

MONTHLY ANNUALLY SAVE 16%



Support \$5

/month



Support \$10

/month

GOLD

- ✓ Everything in the Silver Tier
- ✓ Ad-free access on the HuffPost website OR HuffPost apps
- ✓ Say goodbye to annoying video interruptions while you read. No more autoplay videos.

☐ **Support \$20**
/month

☐ **Make a One Time Contribution**

Join HuffPost

Already a member? [Log in to hide these messages.](#)

RELATED

MELANIA TRUMP

JEFFREY EPSTEIN

MORNING JOE

JOE SCARBOROUGH



Joe Scarborough Points Out Obvious Double Standard In Trump's Easter Morning Meltdown



Melania Trump Distances Herself From Epstein, Calls For Congressional Hearing For Survivors



George Clooney's 'War Crime' Comment Sure Seems To Have Struck A Nerve



Jen Psaki Provides Amused Response To Melania Trump's 'Bananas' Remarks On Epstein

[Go to Homepage](#)

[View 63 Comments](#)



[Suggest a correction](#) | [Submit a tip](#)

TRENDING IN POLITICS



Multiple Women Accuse Rep. Eric Swalwell Of Sexual Assault, Misconduct



'Not For Children': Trump Posts Graphic Video Of Florida Killing, Attributes It To Biden Policies



Jamie Raskin Demands Trump Undergo 'Comprehensive Cognitive Assessment'



Pete Buttigieg Dismantles Pro-Trump Pundit On Iran War: 'Well, That Worked!'



Jen Psaki Provides Amused Response To Melania Trump's 'Bananas' Remarks On Epstein

MORE IN POLITICS



Once Targeted By ICE, Minneapolis-Area School District Celebrates Return Of All Students



Cutting Over \$1 Billion From The Weather-Forecasting Agency Is Part Of Trump's Anti-'Woke' Plan



U.S. And Iran Prepare For High-Level Talks As Israel And Hezbollah Trade More Fire



MTG, Alex Jones And Candace Owens Respond To Trump's 'Rambling' Attack On Them



CNN Reporter Offers Insight Into Timing Of Melania Trump's Epstein Remarks



Trump Admin Dealt Another Blow In Court After Professor Found Not Guilty



Trump Flips Out On 5 Huge Names In MAGA, Proving No One Is Safe If They Go Against Him



Ready To Rumble? Hunter Biden Challenges Trump's Sons To Cage Match



Looks Like Donald Trump Might Not Be Able To Get Rid Of Thomas Massie



Joe Scarborough's Relentless Mockery Of Todd Blanche Causes Whole Show To Lose It



Fox News Host Shares Bleak 'Reality' Of Trump's Ceasefire Deal With Iran



'Who?!': JD Vance Forgets Name Of Senior Vatican Official In Latest Religious Blunder



Democrats Try To Force House Vote On Iran War



CNN Legal Analyst Shreds 'Bogus' DOJ Excuse About Bondi's Epstein Subpoena Into Pieces



'Holy Cow': Democrats Are Making History In Elections Under Trump 2.0, CNN's Harry Enten Says



CNN Host Fires Back At Trump And FCC Head Over Baseless Threats: 'None Of That Is True'



Netanyahu Authorizes Direct Talks With Lebanon In Potential Boost To Ceasefire Efforts



CNBC Host Gives Jaw-Dropping Take On Trump's Iran 'Civilization' Threats



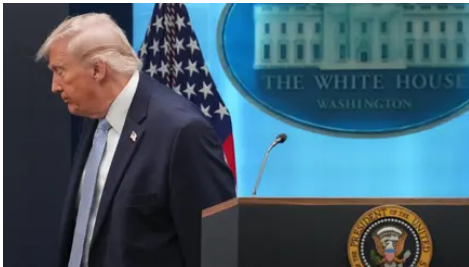
JD Vance Uses Painfully Awkward Analogy To Explain Iran Proposal



California Supreme Court Says Republican Sheriff Must Halt Election Probe



Trump Complains NATO 'Wasn't There When We Needed Them' After Talks With Alliance Leader Rutte



Trump Is Claiming Victory, Even As What Exactly America Won Remains Unclear



Sonia Sotomayor Makes Rare But Damning Critique Of A Fellow Supreme Court Justice



Fox News Host Coins Dubious Term To Defend Trump From TACO Mockery



Michael Moore Blasts Democratic Leaders As 'Cowards' Who Support Trump's Iran War



'Shut Up About That St!': Megyn Kelly Rips Trump Over Threat To Civilians**



CNN Host Begg Pro-Iran War Panelists: 'How About You Guys Actually Deal With Reality?'



**Customs Officer Improperly
Canceled Visa Of Scholar
Charged With Frog Embryo
Smuggling: Judge**



**Pam Bondi Backs Out Of
Deposition On Jeffrey Epstein**



**Ro Khanna Credits 3
Conservative Voices For Helping
Push Trump Into Iran Ceasefire**



**This Old Hillary Clinton Tweet
About Trump Is Suddenly Very
Relevant**



**Teen Loses Eye Due To DHS
Violence At 'No Kings' Protest,
Lawyer Says**



**March Intelligence Report
Warned Of Iran's 'Persistent
Threat' To U.S. As White House
Downplayed The Risk**



**Democratic-Backed Candidate
Wins Wisconsin Supreme Court
Race, Growing Its Liberal
Majority**



**Trump-Endorsed Republican
Wins MTG's Former House Seat
In Georgia**



**Social Media Grossed Out By
Acting AG Todd Blanche's Thirsty
Love For Trump**



**Anti-MAGA Conservative Lets
Loose On Trump Voters With
'Buyer's Remorse': 'F**k You'**



Trump Pulls Back, U.S. And Iran Agree To 2-Week Ceasefire



Republicans Speak Out Against Trump's 'Whole Civilization' Threat



Trump's Acting AG Says Investigating Political Enemies Is The President's 'Duty'



The Supreme Court Just Gave A Big Gift To Free Speech Warriors



These Politicians Have All Called For The 25th Amendment To Be Used Against Trump



Trump's Live Call With Astronauts Goes Way Off Course: 'Quick Comms Check'



Trump's 'Civilization' Threat Isn't Just A War Crime



Mike Johnson, John Thune Silent On Trump's Threat To Destroy 'Whole Civilization'



As Iran War Escalates, Senator Says Military Officers 'Know Their Duty' To Refuse Illegal Orders



Retired U.S. General Predicts 'Nuremberg Trials' If Trump Fulfills 'War Crime' Threat



JD Vance's Live Call To Trump Doesn't Go As Planned



The Far Right Is In All-Out Mutiny After Trump's War Crimes Threat



'A Mockery Of Christianity': Trump And Tucker Carlson Go At It In Angry Back-And-Forth



Trump Threatens 'A Whole Civilization Will Die Tonight' If Deal Not Reached With Iran



James Carville Detects Massive Trouble For GOP Amid Trump's Iran War



CNN Fact-Checker Shreds Trump Over 'Long-Debunked Lies' At Latest Press Conference



Man Who Tried To Remove Tear Gas From Crowd Faces 20 Years In Prison



Iran Calls For Human Chains Around Power Plants As Trump's Deadline Nears



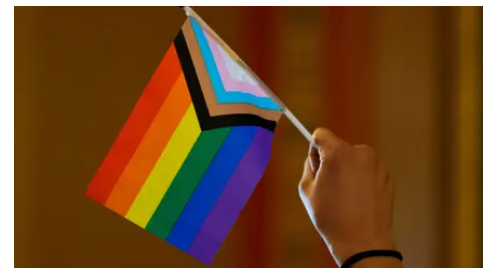
Trump Asked If God Supports His Iran Actions — His Response Is Something Else



'Out Of Control': Democrats Push 25th Amendment After Trump's Iran Rant



'Ultimately, They Will Come For You': Jennifer Siebel Newsom Has Warning For MAGA Women



Iowa Can Enforce Book Ban On LGBTQ+ Topics In K-6 Classes: Appeals Court



**Trump Posts Furious 1AM
Message For Supreme Court**



**Trump Rambles About Autopen,
Joe Biden To Table Full Of Kids
At Easter Event**

**Trump's Iran Escalation Would
Spike Death And Chaos Across
The Mideast**



**Trump Taunts 'Failing' New York 'WTH': Trump Delivers Same,
Times After Reporter Asks About Tired Speech While Easter Bunny
War Crimes Stares Blankly Ahead**



**Ann Coulter Blasts Trump For
'Committing War Crimes' In Iran**



**'Worsening Gradually': MS NOW
Doc Spots 'All The Signs Of
Dementia' In Trump**



**Ceasefire Tested As Israel And
Hezbollah Trade Strikes, Artemis
II Crew Headed For Splashdown:
Live Updates**



**Megyn Kelly: There's No Way
Trump Didn't Know About Bryon
Noem's Alleged Fetish**



**Democrats Clash Over Whether
To Meet With Controversial
Streamer**



**Democrat Gives Pam Bondi's
Replacement A Lesson Worth
Remembering**



**Trump's Unhinged Easter
Message To Iran: 'Open The
F**kin' Strait, You Crazy
Bastards!'**



**MTG Says Trump Needs To Drop
To His Knees And 'Beg
Forgiveness From God' For 'Evil'
Easter Post**



'If Your Children Are Watching, Be Warned': Here's How Networks Covered Trump's F-Word To Iran



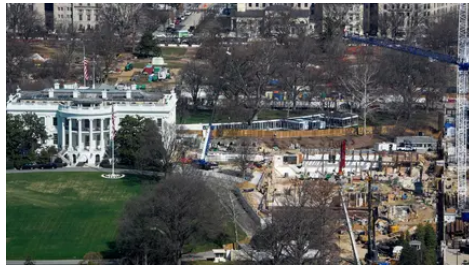
Trump Vows To Strike Civilian Infrastructure If Iran Does Not Reopen Strait Of Hormuz



Trump's Go-It-Alone Certainty Confronts The Uncertainties Of War



Trump Weighs Broader Cabinet Shake-Up As Iran War Pressure Grows



'Time Is Of The Essence!' Trump Administration Appeals Order That Halted White House Ballroom Construction



CNN Host Hits Trump, Hegseth And Leavitt With Awkward Montage Of Iran War Claims

NEWS

POLITICS

ENTERTAINMENT

LIFE

VOICES

HUFFPOST PERSONAL

SHOPPING

NEWSLETTERS

[ABOUT US](#)

[CAREERS](#)

[PRIVACY POLICY](#)

[ADVERTISE](#)

[USER AGREEMENT](#)

[CONSENT PREFERENCES](#)

[CONTACT US](#)

[COMMENT POLICY](#)

[DO NOT SELL OR SHARE MY PERSONAL INFORMATION](#)

[RSS](#)

[DMCA POLICY](#)

[FAQ](#)

[ACCESSIBILITY STATEMENT](#)